TT–I–554a
APRIL 10, 1956

SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. TT–I–554
March 24, 1948, and
Int. Fed. Spec. TT–I–00554a (GPO)
Revision 1
December 7, 1955

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

INK; STAMP-PAD, RED, FOR PHOTOGRAPHIC PRINTS

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers red stamp-pad ink for marking on photographic prints. It is not suitable for other purposes.

1.2 Classification.—The ink shall be of one type and grade.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standard, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

TT–C–595—Colors; (for) Ready-Mixed Paints.
LLL–B–631—Boxes; Fiber Corrugated (for Domestic Shipment).
PPP–B–601—Boxes; Wood, Cleated Plywood.

Military Specifications:

JAN–P–103—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes; Wood Cleated, Solid Fiberboard.
JAN–P–106—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes; Wood Nailed.
MIL–B–107—Boxes; Wood, Wirebound (Overseas Type).
JAN–P–108—Boxes; Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid (Military Type).
MIL–L–10547—Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standard:

MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.—The manufacturer is given wide range in the selection of materials and processes of manufacture, provided that the ink produced meets the requirements of this specification.

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3.2 Properties.—The ink shall be suitable for stamping from a pad, clear, legible impressions on the face of photographic prints. Coagulation or precipitation shall not take place in the ink under ordinary working conditions or when the ink is stored for 1 month at temperatures of 5° C. and 40° C. (41° F. and 104° F.).

3.3 Color.—The color shall be red, similar to shade No. 1105 of Federal Specification TT–C–595.

3.4 Density—Impressions of the ink shall be clearly legible on the face of photographic prints.

3.5 Drying time.—When the ink is applied from a pad with a rubber stamp to the face of a dry photographic print, the ink shall be dry to the touch in not more than 15 seconds, and shall be completely dry in not more than 2 minutes. (See 4.3.2.)

3.6 Solubility.—After the ink has dried completely on the photographic print, it shall be insoluble in water up to 32° C. (90° F.) and shall remain clean-cut, dense, and legible. (See 4.3.3.)

3.7 Inked pad.—The ink shall remain moist on a cloth-covered stamp-pad for at least 30 minutes and produce clear and legible markings. After an application of ink has dried on the stamp-pad, a remoistening of the pad with fresh ink shall make the pad suitable for reuse. (See 4.3.4.)

3.8 Permanence.—The ink markings shall not fade, become brittle, reticulate, or become detached from the print, and shall have sufficient elasticity to withstand folding without chipping.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.—Two samples, each not less than 1 ounce, shall be taken at random from each delivery.

4.2 Material for tests.—Select one normally exposed glossy surfaced print and one normally exposed matte surfaced print, each not less than 5 by 7 inches. Cut each print into four approximately equal parts across the width.

4.3 Inspection and tests.

4.3.1 *Density.*—Saturate a portion of a new, clean stamp-pad with the ink. Press a clean rubber stamp on the pad and apply the stamp to the darkest portion of both the glossy and matte prints. Allow the markings to dry for 2 minutes. Examine the markings for clarity and legibility.

4.3.2 *Drying time.*—The drying time shall be determined at 23° ±5°C. (73.5° ±9°F.) and 50 ±2 percent relative humidity. Ink the rubber stamp and apply markings to pieces of glossy and matte prints. Allow the markings to dry for 15 seconds and immediately touch them with the fingers. This shall produce no discoloration of the fingers. Allow markings to dry for an additional minute and 45 seconds and then rub the markings vigorously with the back of a sheet of photographic paper, after which the photographic paper shall show no discoloration.

4.3.3 *Solubility.*—Allow the prints marked in the density test to dry for not less than 1 hour. Cut the prints in two parts so that each part contains about one-half of the markings. Immerse one part of each print in water having a temperature of 32°C. (90°F.) for 1 hour. Remove the parts and compare the legibility of the markings with those on the parts which are not immersed. The markings on the immersed parts shall show no decrease in density.

4.3.4 *Inked pad.*—Apply the ink to the stamp-pad and expose to the air for 30 minutes. Immediately mark the surfaces of the glossy and matte prints using a clean rubber stamp. Examine the markings for clarity and legibility. Allow the ink to dry on the pad. Remoisten with the ink and determine by marking the prints if the pad is suitable for reuse.

4.3.5 *Permanence.*—Mark two portions of glossy and two portions of the matte prints with a clean rubber stamp and allow the markings to

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dry at 38°C. (100°F.). Expose the markings on two portions, one of each type of print, for 24 hours to the radiation from a Fade-O-meter, Type FDA-R, or its equivalent. Afterward, compare the intensity of the color of the markings with those on the portions which were not exposed. Fold the unexposed prints in such a manner that the fold passes through the markings. Observe if the markings chip or become detached from the prints. Markings on prints tested for permanence shall remain sufficiently legible that there will be no question regarding the exact identity of the markings upon completion of the tests.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging and packing for domestic shipment.

5.1.1 *Packaging.*—Unless otherwise specified, the ink shall be furnished in 1-ounce, circular-base, glass bottles which shall be closed with a suitable screw cap. Each bottle shall be further packaged in an individual chipboard box and sealed with tape.

5.1.2 *Packing.*—Unless otherwise specified, 48 bottles shall be packed in a corrugated fiberboard box conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification LLL–B–631.

5.2 Packaging and packing for overseas shipment.—Ink, packaged and packed as described in 5.1.1 and 5.1.2, shall be further packed in wood-cleated fiberboard, wood-cleated plywood, nailed wood, wood wirebound or fiberboard boxes conforming to the requirements of Military Specification JAN–P–103, Federal Specification PPP–B–601 (overseas type), Military Specifications JAN–P–106, MIL–B–107 and JAN–P–108 compliance symbol V3c or V3s, respectively. Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be provided with waterproof case liners conforming to class 2 of Military Specification MIL–L–10547 and sealed in accordance with appendix thereto. Gross weight of wood and wood-type shipping containers shall not exceed 200 pounds; of fiberboard boxes, 70 pounds.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Packages.*—Unless otherwise specified, each bottle and each chipboard box shall be marked with the following data:

Ink; Stamp-Pad, Red, for Photographic Prints
Federal Specification TT–I–554a
Quantity
Stock number
Order number
Manufacturer's name or trade-mark
CAUTION: DO NOT FREEZE

5.3.2 *Shipping containers.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipments shall be marked as described in 5.3.1 and in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129, as specified.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein. (See 5.1, 5.2, 5.3, and 6.2.)

6.2 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.3 Federal specifications do not include all types, grades, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.4 Transportation description. — Transportation description applicable to this item is:
Ink, printing, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 36,000 pounds.
Truckload minimum weight 36,000 pounds.

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Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—Q
Navy—A S
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 10 cents each.

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